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The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388 sastamps.org T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3

MEETING CALENDAR 2020

NOVEMBER			DECEMBER		
	NO MEETING		?	NO MEETING	
	NO MEETING		?	NO MEETING	
	NO MEETING		?	NO MEETING	
	NO MEETING		?	NO MEETING	
	HAPPY THANKSGIVING			MERRY CHRISTMAS	

EDITOR'S CORNER

7/17/2020

9/24/2020

There is a lot of information about what is happening in the future, so I have made a little list (Mikado, anyone?).

1) Time change is November 1, 2020. At 2:00 am, the time falls back one hour to 1:00 am. Make sure your clocks are updated.

2) We wish all our readers good health to all your families and friends as we celebrate Thanksgiving and Christmas. We hope to see all of you when we can finally meet together to enjoy sharing our love of stamps, and our continuing friendship. Please take care of yourselves and your loved ones during these unhappy times.

3) At this time, we do not forsee any chance of meetings for the rest of the year. That said, if anything changes so that we can hold our meetings, we will let you know ASAP. This means that the information will go on our website at **sastamps.org**, and an information flier will be mailed to all of you with times and what we will need to do follow Covid protocols to enable us to keep meetings safe for all of us and the church members also.

4) It has been decided that the members of the Board of Governors will continue in office until we are able to hold an election meeting. The timing will be settled as soon as meetings resume. In the meantime, thanks to our officers who are so ably keeping us going.

LEA SENGHAAS & DORA ROBERTS

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta

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Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
Philatex Editors
334 Olney Dr.
San Antonio, Tx 78209
Or email either of us.
lys@satx.rr.com dora.roberts@hotmail.com

Write to SAPA at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
P.O. Box 33113
San Antonio, TX 78265

SAPA meets at MacArthur Park Lutheran Church, 2903 Nacogdoches Rd, every Friday night at 7:30 pm in Bldg. #1, facing Nacogdoches Rd. Yearly dues are $20.00, prorated.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
Vice President:	Chip Swinney
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chair:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chair:	George Garten
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Chip Swinney
Assistant Auctioneers:	Steve Mabie

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Jack Virta
One year term:	Nancy Mabie
Two year term:	Lea Senghaas
Parliamentarian:	Harry Greer
Honorary Board Member	Kathy Beer

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Texas Philatelic Association:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
APS Circuit Books	Dr. Eric Shepherd

WE WELCOME VISITORS

Please view our website **sastamps.org** for information on our meeting schedules

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourses and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

While your purchases will be given to you during the auction, please wait until the end of the auction to pay for them. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks made out to S.A.P.A. are acceptable. Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

President's Message

Dear Members,

As was predicted by many health professionals, we are seeing a surge on Covid-19 cases this fall. How bad it will be no one can say. The church where we meet is taking a sensible approach to banning all in-person meetings for the rest of the year and maybe several months into 2021. The SAPA Board agrees with this decision as regards our members. The current officers will continue to serve into 2021 and we will come back stronger than ever when this crisis is over.

I have been reading a history of the 1918 Spanish Flu Pandemic (Pale Rider by Laura Spinney). It is scary how the reaction of the population then is almost the same as it is now. Back them no one even knew what a virus was, there were no antibiotics to treat the secondary infections and there was no high tech medicine such as ventilators or drugs to treat the symptoms. They just had to wait several years for the pandemic to burn itself out. The 1918 pandemic killed an estimated 50 to 100 million worldwide before it was over. Even today with our state of the art medicine we may have to wait until a vaccine is developed to treat enough people around the world to stop this pandemic. Read this book. *Dr. Eric Shepherd*

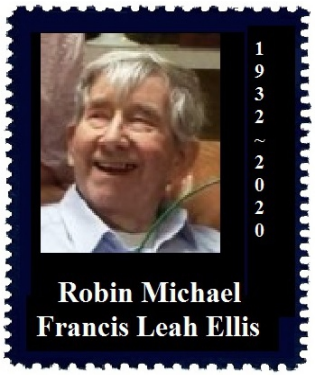
Nov. 2020 phone **210-906-2655**

BAG NIGHT STAMPS

There are still many bags of stamps left over from "Bag Night." As you know, we were only able to have one "Bag Night" this past year before we were shut down. These are great stamps – all are off paper. Two bags were never searched by anyone and are available for $10 each. Quite a few bags were searched by only one person and are available for $3 each. Finally, the bags that were searched by two or more persons can be yours for $1 each. These bags will definitely give you something interesting to do during these days of isolation. If interested in one or more of these bags, contact Steve or Nancy Mabie, (210) 490-9997. We can meet you somewhere safe to make the exchange. Thank you! *Nancy Mabie* *Nov.2020*

SA&ST POSTCARD CLUB

Like just about everything else, the San Antonio & South Texas Postcard Club has been unable to meet because of the restrictions imposed by the COVID-19 pandemic. Until the restaurants are able to reopen to their full capacity, we will not be holding any meetings. If you would like any information about the San Antonio & South Texas Postcard Club, please contact the club secretary, Nancy Mabie at NRMabie@gmail.com. *Nov. 2020*



CLOSED ALBUMS

Robin Michael Francis Leah Ellis, SAPA #2417, joined in 1985, and was Vice-President of our club from 2014-2017. He was born April 6, 1932, in Chirk, North Wales, and died July 3, 2020 in San Antonio, Tx.

In 1950, when he was 18, he moved to the US. He enlisted in the Army, and served during the Korean War and in Vietnam as a photo journalist for the War Department. He received three Bronze Stars and various meritorious certificates.

Robin's passion was military history and stamp collecting having amassed a large holding. His collection was distributed to five different archives here in San Antonio and most notably two vans worth of documents given to the Nimitz Museum in Fredericksburg.

Robin served on the Board of the Society for the Preservation of Historic Fort Sam Houston and assisted with the restoration of Stillwell House there on base. He volunteered with the San Antonio Historical Association serving as that organization's Treasurer, and put in many hours volunteering with the San Antonio Conservation Society.

Robin was a gentleman. The quintessential soldier, an astute collector, and a superb preservationist. His contributions will be carried forth into the future through his generous donations to our local archives and museums.

He will be missed by all who knew him.

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

Nov 6-7 HOUSTON TSDA Crowne Plaza Hotel, 7611 Katy Freeway (IH-10 West), Houston, TX 77024. (Fri 10-5, Sat 9-4) **Covid-19 : Event status cannot be confirmed**

Nov 13-14 MID CITIES STAMP EXPO, show will be held at the spacious Grapevine Convention Center in Grapevine, Texas. This event is for stamp collectors. The exhibition will feature 768 pages of stamp collections; 21 stamp dealers, a giant mixture pick and a beginning collector table with free stamps. Free Parking & Free Admission. (Fri 10-5, Sat 9-4) **Covid-19 : Event status cannot be confirmed**

Dec 4-5 DALLAS TSDA CANCELED

STAMP COLLECTING IN THE FUTURE BY SPENCER COSBY.

(Toronto Philatelic Journal, April 1886)

Canada 2c Large Queen postage stamp on laid paper 1868

A number of articles have been making the rounds of the philatelic papers with such titles as "Stamp Collecting in 1986," "A Stamp Collector 200 years from now," etc. The idea is nearly the same in all of them, and usually runs about as follows: The philatelist of 1986 or 2086, or of whatever future century he may be, owns a collection numbering anywhere from fifty thousand to one hundred and fifty thousand varieties, contained in a dozen or more folio volumes, and requiring several days to be looked over. His greatest rarity is some such stamp as the two cent U.S. 1883 issue, or the three cent 1870 issue, or some other stamp common perhaps in the 19th century, but whose origin and use is now clothed in obscurity.

Articles of the above nature may be amusing, and indeed I suppose that is their object, as I do not think they give at all a correct idea of what stamp collecting will be in the future. It seems much more probable that as the number of stamps increases, collectors will become specialists and devote their attention to certain branches oh philately only. This is the case in numismatics, for we only find young collectors taking coins of all nations and of all ages indiscriminately. By the time that thirty or forty thousand different stamps have been issued the number of collectors will probably be three or four times as large as it is now, and the value of obsolete stamps will have increased proportionately. The consequence will be that persons of moderate means and with no great amount of spare time will find it an utter impossibility to obtain a complete collection, and only dealers who devote their whole time to the business, and persons with plenty of money who make it their hobby will even attempt to collect stamps of all kinds. The great majority of philatelists will take up some branch suited to their means and in which they feel particular interest. Some will only collect the stamps of their own country, others will select certain countries and confine their attention to them, others again will collect only those stamps issued between certain dates.

In fact, although the number of postage stamps that have appeared up to the present day is comparatively small, many collectors have already become specialists, and a movement in that direction seems to have already begun. In Europe nearly all the advanced philatelists collect all kinds of stamps, postage, revenue, telegraph, postal cards, etc. In this country very few collectors care for revenues, and those who do keep them separate from their postage stamps. Postal cards seem also to be generally neglected, and it is only lately that persons have begun to collect envelope stamps on the whole envelope, as many consider them to have lost much of their value if cut from it. There is a large and growing class of collectors who collect only U.S. stamps and some few are beginning to discard all provisionals.

This movement towards become specialists will, in all likelihood, steadily continue, and it will not be long before it will be an exception to find a person collecting even all varieties of postage stamps. Of course this will only be the case if new issues continue to appear as often as they do now, and from present appearances we should judge that they would. But none of us know what the future may have in store for philately, and indeed in the onward march of invention it is not at all improbable that some new and improved system of prepayment of postage may be devised which will entirely do away with the use of stamps, so that but for collectors their very existence might be forgotten a few centuries hence. – The Stamp and Coin Gazette.

(This article is from **stamporama.com** *Historic Articles. Stamporama is an interesting club to belong to online. The stamp illustration I found is of an extremely rare variety - 3 are known. It would probably have been more common in 1886. Lea Senghaas, ed.)*

Fred's Corner:

The National Postal Museum (www.postalmuseum.si.edu) continues to publicize its internet activities. It will host the 17th Maynard Sundman Lecture Wednesday, Dec. 9, at 4 p.m. ET online, via Zoom. Admission to the lecture is free, but registration is required. Register at: https://postalmuseum.si.edu/maynard-sundman-lecture-series

The museum will welcome Yamil Kouri Jr. to discuss the topic of his most recent book "Under Three Flags, the Postal History of the Spanish-Cuban/American War," the winner of the American Philatelic Society's philatelic literature Grand Award in 2019. Cubans had long sought liberation from Spanish rule during the mid-to-late 19th century, culminating in the Cuban War of Independence in 1895. After more than three years of fighting, neither side had a clear advantage. The United States' declaration of war against Spain in April 1898 had a decisive impact on the conflict, leading to Spain's surrender within a few months. Although brief, these coinciding military conflicts and the multi-country occupation of Cuba produced a rich and varied postal history legacy. The presentation will explore some of the fascinating aspects of this legacy that resulted in major global consequences.

A reminder that the APS is on YouTube with all sorts of material for collectors and non-collectors. Visit at:

https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCK_7NRrkyCZbnVqj4gEofFw?view_as=subscriber

I have received an email from Rod Henderson, Newsletter Editor, Huntsville Philatelic Club, soliciting support for his proposal to the Citizen's Stamp Advisory Committee for a commemorative stamp to honor the Air Force Hurricane Hunters. He has attached to his email a sample letter (as well as a sample endorsement of the request) to the committee detailing his request, along with photos. The email is too large to attach to this message. However, if anyone is interested in this topic, let me know, and I will forward Rod's email to you.

APS STAMP CHATS: APS is conducting virtual stamp chats weekly on Zoom Webinar. Topics are varied, and a session runs around one hour.

You do not have to be an APS member to participate (but, why not join APS?). You can get further information (topics and schedules) on these chats by going to the APS front page (stamps.org) and click on the Stamp Chats block.

Most of these chats are available on the APS YouTube Channel. Some chats may be restricted to APS members. For most chats, though, you just have to sign up for YouTube.

VIRTUAL STAMP SHOW WINNING EXHIBITS

If you would like to view these exhibits at the recent virtual show, go the APS front page (stamps.org) and click on the block with this name. You can then view your favorite exhibit. This may not be the same as looking in person, but you can still get up close and personal electronically.

Stay safe and healthy!

Fred Groth, Treasurer